

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 167

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor Jeff Kelly, Public Defender for the First Judicial District, on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Jeff Kelly, as Public Defender for the First Judicial District, has excelled in his statutory mission of representing individuals who cannot afford a private attorney; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Kelly and his staff have accomplished this mission by ably representing their clients in the courts of Carter, Johnson, Unicoi, and Washington counties; and

WHEREAS, Jeff Kelly is taking a much-deserved retirement after an exemplary career with the Public Defenders Conference that spans thirty-five years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Kelly was appointed First Judicial District Public Defender in September 2009 by Governor Phil Bredesen and was first elected to the post in 2010; and

WHEREAS, prior to his appointment, he served with distinction as an Assistant Public Defender for the First Judicial District for twenty years; and

WHEREAS, recognized as a leader by his peers and colleagues, Jeff Kelly has served the Tennessee Public Defenders Conference as a member of its Legislative, Technology, Ad-Hoc Staffing Criteria, Ad-Hoc Administrative Staff Salary, Education, and Training committees; and

WHEREAS, an alumnus of Milligan College, he earned his law degree at the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Kelly has given back to his community through his involvement in the local bar association, Rotary, and various community projects and is an active member of Hopwood Christian Church; and

WHEREAS, a fan of college sports, he is a natural handyman and looks forward to tackling his next big project during retirement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Kelly cannot wait to spend more time with his family, which includes his loving wife of thirty years, Julie Ann Kelly; their children, Devin Johnson, Holley Kelly, Will Kelly, and Olivia Kelly; and grandchildren, Bryn Johnson, Rowan Johnson, Cecily Johnson, and Edith Johnson; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Jeff Kelly demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of members of the bar and bench and his community alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Jeff Kelly, Public Defender for the First Judicial District, on the occasion of his retirement, salute his thirty-five-year career spent serving the citizens of Carter, Johnson, Unicoi, and Washington counties, and extend to him our best wishes for enjoying the fruits of his labor.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.